

SAVITRIBAI PHULE PUNE UNIVERSITY

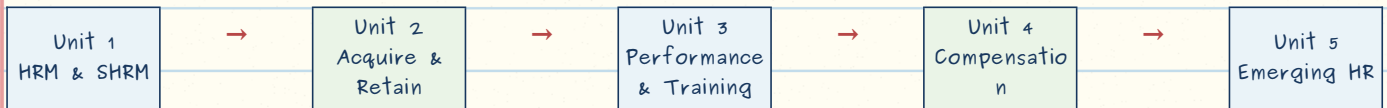
HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

Handwritten Summary Notes

Most Important & Repeated PYQs - 2022 to 2025

Only high-yield concepts, compact diagrams and topper answer points.
No unnecessary theory.

5-UNIT REVISION PATH



What is inside?

- Only the most examinable concepts from all five units.
- Repeated questions mapped from 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025 papers.
- Answer skeletons for high-probability 5-mark and 10-mark questions.
- Quick comparisons, diagrams, examples and a 30-minute revision sheet.
- Best revision order: Unit 2 → Unit 3 → Unit 5 → Unit 4 → Unit 1.

Exam rule: define → draw → explain → example → conclude.

PYQ PRIORITY MAP - 2022 TO 2025

Theme	Repeat	Prepare
Job Analysis / JD / JS	Every year	Meaning, methods, uses, comparison + job example
Recruitment & Selection	Every year	Sources, process, differences + selection case
Performance Appraisal	Every year	Process, methods, errors, appraisal vs PM
Training & Development	Every year	TNA, process, methods, Kirkpatrick
Strategic HRM / HR role	Every year	Administrative to strategic role + challenges
Compensation / Incentives	Every year	Components, factors, equity, incentive design
HRIS	Every year	Uses, design, implementation, benefits and risks
HRP	3+ years	Process, forecasting, gap action and barriers
Career / Succession	2+ years	Process and shared roles
HR Audit / HRA	Repeated alternate	Audit process/report; HRA methods/limits

TOPPER ANSWER FORMULA



- **10 marks:** 2-line introduction + diagram + 7 explained headings + example + limitation + conclusion.
- **5 marks:** definition + five points or a comparison table + one example.
- **2 marks:** precise definition + two features; do not write a story.

Minimum safe preparation: 15 answer frames + 8 diagrams + one example for every unit.

UNIT 1 – HRM CONCEPT, CHALLENGES & SHRM

Exam priority: HIGH. Strategic HR role appears consistently across the four papers.

1. HRM – core summary

- **Meaning:** planned process of acquiring, developing, motivating, maintaining and retaining people to achieve individual and organisational goals.
- **Nature:** people-oriented, pervasive, continuous, action-focused, development-oriented and strategically integrated.
- **Objectives:** right person-right job, competence, motivation, fair treatment, growth, compliance and effectiveness.
- **Functions:** HRP, job analysis, recruitment, selection, induction, training, appraisal, compensation, relations, safety and separation.
- **Policy vs practice:** policy gives broad guidance; practice is the actual method used to implement it.

HRM cycle



2. Strategic HRM (SHRM)

- **Meaning:** links HR policies and workforce capability with long-term business strategy.
- **Shift in role:** from records and payroll to talent, culture, change, analytics and business partnership.
- **Fit:** vertical fit with strategy + horizontal fit among recruitment, appraisal, reward and development systems.
- **Example:** a logistics firm pursuing fast delivery recruits route-analytics talent, trains supervisors and rewards on-time delivery.

Harvard model: stakeholders → situational factors → HR choices → HR outcomes → long-term consequences.

Matching model: business strategy → HR strategy → aligned selection, appraisal, rewards and development.

UNIT 1 – MOST IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

Q. Explain why HR must transform from an administrative function to a strategic contributor. [VERY HIGH | Strategic theme in all 4 years]

Topper answer points: Start with the changing business environment. Explain strategic alignment, talent advantage, culture/change, workforce planning, analytics, productivity, risk/compliance and employee experience. Add an example. Conclude that routine work may be automated, but strategic people decisions create competitive advantage.

Q. Discuss major challenges before HRM and suggest responses. [VERY HIGH | 2023 + repeated theme]

Topper answer points: Write challenge-response pairs: skill shortage → planning and reskilling; technology → digital learning/job redesign; diversity → inclusion; remote work → outcome-based performance; retention → career/rewards; privacy → governance; globalisation → cross-cultural capability; stress → wellbeing.

Q. Differentiate HRM and HRD. [HIGH | 2022 + short-answer recurrence]

Topper answer points: HRM is the wider system covering acquisition, rewards, relations and development; HRD is the development subsystem. Compare scope, objective, time focus, tools, responsibility and output. Example: recruitment is HRM; leadership training is HRD.

Basis	HRM	SHRM
Focus	Efficient people administration	Strategic advantage through people
Time	Short / medium term	Long term
Responsibility	Mainly HR department	HR + managers + leadership
Measures	Activities and compliance	Business outcomes and capability
Approach	Reactive	Proactive and integrated

UNIT 2 – HR ACQUISITION & RETENTION

Exam priority: VERY HIGH. Job analysis, recruitment and selection appeared every year.

1. Human Resource Planning (HRP)

- **Meaning:** forecast future HR demand and supply, identify gaps and take action.
- **Need:** prevent shortage/surplus, support expansion, control cost, prepare succession and improve deployment.
- **Demand methods:** managerial judgement, ratio-trend, workload and statistical forecasting.
- **Supply sources:** skills inventory, replacement chart, succession plan, internal mobility and labour market.
- **Barriers:** poor data, uncertain strategy, resistance, short-term thinking and weak manager participation.

HRP process



2. Job Analysis, JD and JS

- **Job analysis:** systematic collection of job duties, responsibilities, conditions and required competencies.
- **Methods:** observation, interview, questionnaire, diary/log, critical incident and work records.
- **Outputs:** Job Description = job content; Job Specification = person requirements.
- **Uses:** recruitment, selection, training, appraisal, compensation, safety and redesign.



UNIT 2 – RECRUITMENT, SELECTION & RETENTION

3. Recruitment vs Selection

Basis	Recruitment	Selection
Meaning	Attract a pool of applicants	Choose the most suitable applicant
Nature	Positive process	Screening / rejection process
Sequence	Before selection	After recruitment
Methods	Internal and external sources	Tests, interviews, checks, medical
Result	Applicant pool	Appointment decision

- **Internal sources:** promotion, transfer, job posting, referrals and rehiring. Quick and motivating, but may limit fresh talent.

Selection funnel



4. Induction, Career, Succession and Retention

- **Induction:** introduces the new employee to job, people, rules, safety and culture.
- **Career planning:** self-assessment → opportunities → goals → development plan → movement → review.
- **Succession planning:** identifies critical roles and prepares ready-now and ready-later successors.
- **Retention levers:** fair pay, meaningful work, manager quality, recognition, growth, flexibility, wellbeing and trust.
- **Enlargement vs enrichment:** more tasks at same level vs more autonomy, responsibility and decision-making.

UNIT 2 – MOST IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

Q. Explain the HRP process and barriers to effective HRP. [VERY HIGH | 2022-2024]

Topper answer points: Define HRP and draw six steps. Explain objective analysis, demand forecast, supply forecast, gap analysis, action plans (recruit, train, redeploy, outsource, reduce) and monitoring. Add barriers/remedies. Example: warehouse staffing before peak season.

Q. Explain job analysis and distinguish JD from JS. [VERY HIGH | Every year]

Topper answer points: Define job analysis, methods and uses. JD contains title, purpose, duties, reporting, authority, conditions and KPIs. JS contains education, experience, skills, knowledge and traits. Add one HR Executive or Logistics Manager example.

Q. Design a selection process for a managerial position. [VERY HIGH | 2022, 2024, 2025 cases]

Topper answer points: Approved need + competency JD/JS → targeted sourcing → screening → aptitude/technical test → work sample/case → structured behavioural interview → reference/background check → medical if relevant → weighted decision → offer and induction. Add validity, fairness and records.

Q. Explain career planning and the roles of employee, manager and organisation.

[HIGH | 2024-2025]

Topper answer points: Employee: self-assessment, goals, learning. Manager: feedback, coaching, opportunities. Organisation: career paths, assessment, vacancies, mentoring and succession. Conclude with shared responsibility.

UNIT 3 – PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

Exam priority: VERY HIGH. Appraisal/performance themes appeared in all four papers.

1. Appraisal vs Performance Management

Basis	Performance Appraisal	Performance Management
Nature	Periodic rating event	Continuous management process
Focus	Past/current performance	Goals, coaching, development, future results
Responsibility	Often HR-driven	Manager and employee jointly
Output	Rating / decision	Improvement, alignment and capability

Performance management cycle



2. Methods, errors and controls

- **Traditional methods:** ranking, paired comparison, graphic scale, checklist, confidential report and essay.
- **Modern methods:** MBO, BARS, 360-degree feedback, assessment centre and Balanced Scorecard.
- **Rating errors:** halo, horn, leniency, strictness, central tendency, recency, similarity and personal bias.
- **Controls:** clear standards, rater training, multiple evidence sources, calibration, documentation and appeal.
- **Best for managers:** MBO for results + BARS for behaviour + 360 feedback for leadership, supported by coaching.

UNIT 3 – TRAINING & DEVELOPMENT

- **Training:** improves current-job knowledge and skills. Development prepares for future and broader roles.
- **TNA levels:** organisation = where; task/job = what; person = who needs training.
- **On-the-job:** coaching, job rotation, apprenticeship and understudy.
- **Off-the-job:** lecture, simulation, case, role play, vestibule and e-learning.
- **Management development:** assessment centre, action learning, mentoring, coaching, business games and assignments.

Training process



Kirkpatrick Training Evaluation

Level	Question	Measure
1. Reaction	Was it relevant and engaging?	Feedback / confidence
2. Learning	What knowledge or skill changed?	Pre-post test / demonstration
3. Behaviour	Was learning used on the job?	Observation / manager review
4. Results	What business result improved?	Quality, cost, safety, sales

- **Example:** for warehouse safety training measure feedback, post-test score, safe behaviour and reduction in accidents.
- **Potential appraisal:** asks what higher or different future role the employee can handle; supports succession and development.

UNIT 3 – MOST IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

Q. Explain traditional and modern appraisal methods. Recommend a method for managers. [VERY HIGH | 2022-2025]

Topper answer points: Define appraisal. Explain traditional then modern methods with merits/limits. Recommend MBO + BARS + 360 feedback with clear KPIs, rater training and calibration. No single method fully captures results, behaviour and leadership.

Q. Explain the training and development process with an example. [VERY HIGH | Every year]

Topper answer points: Use six stages: TNA, measurable objectives, design, method/resources, delivery, evaluation and transfer. Add an operational example and link evaluation to Kirkpatrick. Training succeeds only when behaviour and results improve.

Q. Explain the Kirkpatrick model of training evaluation. [HIGH | 2024 + 2025 evaluation theme]

Topper answer points: Draw four levels: Reaction, Learning, Behaviour and Results. Define each, give one measure and add a workplace example. Higher levels give stronger evidence but need more time and controls.

Q. Distinguish performance appraisal and potential appraisal. [HIGH | 2023 + related questions]

Topper answer points: Compare time focus, central question, evidence, methods and uses. Performance appraisal evaluates current/past results; potential appraisal predicts future capability for higher/different roles. Link both to development.

UNIT 4 – COMPENSATION MANAGEMENT

Exam priority: HIGH. Components and incentives are the safest long-answer preparation.

1. Meaning, objectives and process

- **Compensation:** all financial and non-financial returns received for employment.
- **Objectives:** attract, retain, motivate, ensure fairness, comply with law, control cost and reinforce performance.
- **Factors:** job worth, ability to pay, market rate, performance, skill, union, law, location and cost of living.
- **Process:** job analysis → evaluation → market survey → pay policy → grades/ranges → incentives/benefits → communication → review.

Total rewards



2. Equity, incentives and benefits

- **Internal equity:** fair relative pay among jobs inside the organisation; supported by job evaluation and grades.
- **External competitiveness:** pay position compared with market; supported by salary surveys and lead/match/lag policy.
- **Individual incentives:** piece rate, commission, merit pay and bonus. Team incentives: gainsharing, team/project bonus.
- **Good plan:** measurable, controllable, simple, fair, quality-protected, timely and regularly reviewed.
- **Fringe benefits:** retirement, insurance, leave, medical, transport, meals, education and flexible benefits.

UNIT 4 – IMPORTANT QUESTIONS + GRIEVANCE

Q. Explain the components of compensation with reference to an IT organisation.

[VERY HIGH | 2024 + repeated theme]

Topper answer points: Classify as fixed direct pay, variable direct pay, indirect benefits and non-financial rewards. Explain balance, fairness and market competitiveness. Use IT examples: skill allowance, project bonus, health cover, learning and flexibility.

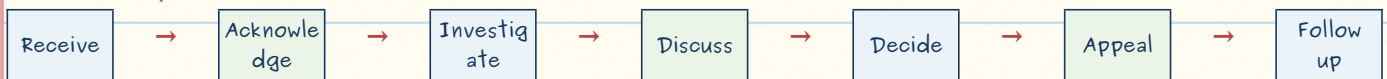
Q. Design a fair incentive system for individual and team work. [HIGH | 2023 case + 2025 incentives]

Topper answer points: Define objectives and roles; choose controllable KPIs; combine individual/team weight; add quality/customer/safety gates; set thresholds/caps; transparent formula; validate data; communicate, appeal and review. Prevent free-riding and unhealthy competition.

Q. Explain the grievance handling procedure. [HIGH | 2024]

Topper answer points: Employee raises issue → supervisor discussion → written grievance → HR investigation → committee/management decision → appeal/arbitration → follow-up.
Principles: speed, confidentiality, natural justice, records, non-retaliation and consistency.

Grievance procedure



- **Separation:** resignation, retirement, discharge, layoff, retrenchment and dismissal. Positive separation requires respect, compliance, final settlement, knowledge transfer and exit feedback.

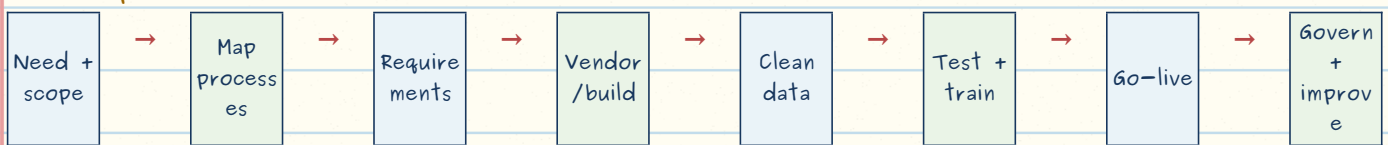
UNIT 5 – EMERGING TRENDS IN HRM

Exam priority: HIGH. HRIS is VERY HIGH and appeared every year.

1. Human Resource Information System (HRIS)

- **Meaning:** integrated people, process, data and technology system for HR transactions, reporting and decisions.
- **Modules:** employee master, recruitment, attendance, payroll, performance, learning, compensation and analytics.
- **Uses:** speed, accuracy, self-service, compliance, workforce planning, dashboards and better decisions.
- **Risks:** poor data, privacy breach, resistance, integration failure, over-customisation and weak controls.

HRIS implementation



2. Human Resource Audit

- **Meaning:** systematic examination of HR policies, records, compliance, efficiency and contribution.
- **Scope:** planning, recruitment, training, appraisal, pay, relations, safety, records, compliance and metrics.
- **Process:** objectives → standards → evidence → gap analysis → findings → recommendations → follow-up.
- **Report:** summary, scope, method, finding, risk, root cause, recommendation, owner and timeline.

UNIT 5 – HRA, SHARED SERVICES & QUESTIONS

3. Human Resource Accounting (HRA)

- **Meaning:** measurement/reporting of employee-related investment or value for managerial decisions.
- **Methods:** cost methods – historical, replacement and opportunity cost; value methods – future earnings/economic value.
- **Advantages and limits:** highlights people investment and supports decisions, but valuation is subjective, ethically sensitive and not universally accepted.

4. HR Shared Services

- **Meaning:** centralised delivery of common HR transactions through standard processes, service centre and self-service.
- **Benefits/risks:** consistency, lower cost and better data; may feel impersonal and create transition/accountability issues.

Q. Explain how an organisation should design and manage an HRIS. [VERY HIGH | Every year; 10 marks in 2022 and 2025]

Topper answer points: Business need and governance → process mapping → requirements → solution choice → data standards and privacy → integration → testing → change/training → phased go-live → support → metrics and improvement. Measure accuracy, adoption and cycle time.

Q. Explain objectives, scope and process of HR Audit and outline the audit report. [HIGH | 2022-2023]

Topper answer points: Objectives: compliance, effectiveness, risk reduction and improvement. Cover full HR lifecycle. Explain evidence, comparison with criteria, risk-ranked findings and corrective action. Report should name evidence, impact, owner and deadline.

Q. Explain methods, advantages and limitations of HRA. [HIGH | 2022 + alternate long answer]

Topper answer points: Define HRA. Classify cost and value methods, explain each briefly, discuss decision benefits and practical limits. Conclude HRA is a managerial-information tool, not a perfectly objective valuation.

MOST EXPECTED QUESTION LIST - ALL UNITS

Unit	10-mark preparation	5 / 2-mark preparation
1	HR admin to strategic transformation; challenges and responses	HRM vs HRD; HRM vs SHRM; importance of SHRM; Harvard/Matching
2	HRP + barriers; selection case; JD/JS for a job; career planning	Job analysis; internal sources; JD vs JS; enlargement vs enrichment; induction
3	Appraisal methods; training process; appraisal process	Kirkpatrick; TNA; appraisal vs PM; performance vs potential; coaching
4	Compensation components; incentive-system case	Internal vs external equity; grievance; benefits; separation
5	HRIS design; HR Audit; HRA	Uses of HRIS; audit report; shared services

Learn the 15 answer frames in this booklet and practise these eight diagrams.

Eight must-draw diagrams

- HRM cycle
- HRP process
- Job analysis → JD + JS
- Selection funnel
- Performance management cycle
- Training cycle + Kirkpatrick
- Total rewards + grievance flow
- HRIS implementation + HR audit cycle

Case-study formula



- **Topper rule:** never dump generic theory. Connect each recommendation to a case fact, risk or expected outcome.

30-MINUTE RAPID REVISION SHEET

Term	One-line recall
HRM	Acquire, develop, reward, maintain and retain people to achieve goals.
SHRM	Align HR systems and workforce capability with business strategy.
HRP	Forecast demand and supply, identify gaps and take action.
Job Analysis	Systematic study of job duties and person requirements.
JD / JS	JD describes the job; JS describes the suitable person.
Recruitment / Selection	Attract applicants / choose the best-fit applicant.
Induction	Planned introduction of a new employee to job and organisation.
Career / Succession	Plan employee growth / ensure successors for critical roles.
Performance Management	Continuous goal, coaching, review and development process.
Appraisal	Periodic evaluation of performance against standards.
TNA	Identify where, what and who requires training.
Kirkpatrick	Reaction → Learning → Behaviour → Results.
Compensation	Financial and non-financial returns for employment.
Internal / External equity	Fairness inside / competitiveness with labour market.
Grievance	Employee dissatisfaction formally presented for resolution.
HRIS	Integrated HR data and process system for transactions and decisions.
HR Audit	Systematic examination of HR compliance, efficiency and effectiveness.
HRA	Measurement/reporting of employee-related cost or value.
Shared Services	Centralised standard delivery of common HR services.

Final check: definitions → comparisons → diagrams → 15 repeated questions → examples → conclusions.

Topper closing line for most answers:

“Therefore, the HR system should be strategically aligned, data-supported, fair, employee-centred and continuously reviewed for measurable organisational outcomes.”